



7-11-2023 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=trqthighruQ
Publication Date	2023-07-12T10:02:43Z
Target Category	mcs

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

Omitted: No statutory public hearings or committee sessions were held immediately prior to the regular meeting call to order.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by the presiding officer. Opening statements noted that school is less than a month away, with classes starting August 8th.
- **Attendance:**
 - Presiding Officer / Board Members present (identified through discussion/motion context): Dr. Kraakowski (Superintendent), Brad Jerome (Director of Business), Dr. Bell, Jim Williams, Chuck Low, Mr. Heater, Mr. Irvin, and Tasha (board member).
 - Members Absent: None explicitly stated.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:53](#).

- **Approval of Minutes:** Prior meeting minutes and regular agenda items were handled via the consent agenda (see Section 4).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:19:16 Consent Agenda (Personnel Reports, IEP Writing Stipends, & Annual TAG Policies)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Leadership & Administration / Brad Jerome.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion covered stipends for special education teachers writing Individualized Education Programs (IEPs) outside of substitute days, annual renewal of the Personnel Annual TAG Policies (no fundamental changes), and the personnel/hiring report. Newly hired 4th-grade teacher Sarah Bradford introduced herself to the board.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:22:37 Financial Report (June Financial Snapshot & Debt Service Update)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome, Director of Business.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Jerome presented the six-month financial snapshot. The State Basic Grant received in June was \$3.4 million (projected over \$43.6 million annually); local property tax distribution was over \$3.5 million; payroll is up due to raises and headcount; cash balance at the end of June stood at over \$33.8 million (projected over \$30 million by calendar year-end; Education Fund at \$13.6 million). Long-term debt payments of over \$6.1 million were made in June to pay off the 2014 General Obligation (GO) Bond balloon payments, with another \$6 million due in December. The state loan is down to \$10.2 million. Board members highlighted the upcoming full payoff of the 2014 GO Bond in December as a major milestone.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:27:38 Business Office Procedures and Protocol (Internal Controls)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome, Director of Business.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual review and sign-off of internal financial controls as required by the State Board of Accounts. Business office staff, principals, and Extra-Curricular Activities (ECA) treasurers review and sign. No substantive changes from prior years except personnel name updates. Duties are strictly segregated across accounts payable entry, coding, and check printing.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:31:25 Amended Collaboration Agreement with the YMCA (Aquatics & Pool Contribution)**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Leadership / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Follows up on the December 13, 2022 agreement regarding high school aquatics programming. Due to inflation, maintaining an 8-lane competition pool rather than a 6-lane pool required an incremental cost increase. Muncie Community Schools agreed to contribute an additional \$365,400 on or before March 1, 2024, in exchange for MCS aquatics program use.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:17:21 Mr. Answer (Resident):**
 - Commented on reading curricula, expressing support for a return to fundamental phonics approaches rather than newer exploratory methods.
 - Raised concerns regarding whether the Muncie Central High School football stadium will be fully ready for the start of the school year due to visible construction delays.
 - Questioned public funding allocations involving the YMCA, raising concerns regarding faith-based affiliations and member-only restrictions.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **School Construction Updates:** Brad Jerome reported that projects at Westview, South View, and North View (including portable modules) remain on schedule for the August 8th start of school. At Muncie Central High School, remaining steel for home bleachers arrives July 17th, and home football games remain scheduled for later in August. Specialized trailer restrooms ("sophisticated porta-potties") and fencing/gates will be utilized while permanent restroom/concession buildings are completed.
 - **Travel & Collaborative Programs:** Staff and board members are traveling to Racine, Wisconsin, to study cradle-to-career and workplace learning models, and a separate trip is planned to the Harlem Children's Zone.
 - **Staffing & Retention:** Teacher retention has risen to 84% (the highest percentage during current administration tenure), driven by recent salary increases and leadership support. Ongoing recruitment focus remains on instructional assistants.
 - **Adjournment:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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